Very Simple Recipes that You Shouldn't Mess Up

Recipe Notes for a Beginner Culinary Student

Overview

Listed below are 5 basic recipes that culinary students should already know by heart — meaning you should already memorize all the steps and ingredients without looking at the notes.

1. Grilled Cheese Sandwich

Ingredients

- 2 slices of bread
- 2 slices of cheese
- 1–2 tablespoons butter

Steps

1. Butter one side of each slice of bread.
2. Heat a pan over medium-low heat and place one slice of bread butter-side down.
3. Add the cheese and top with the second slice of bread, butter-side up.
4. Cook for 2–3 minutes on each side until golden brown and the cheese is melted.
5. Remove from the pan, cut, and serve.

2. Cheese Quesadilla

Ingredients

- 2 flour tortillas
- 1 cup shredded cheese
- 1 teaspoon butter or oil

Steps

1. Heat a pan over medium heat and lightly grease it.

2. Place one tortilla in the pan and add cheese to one half.
3. Fold the tortilla in half and cook for 2–3 minutes.
4. Flip and cook for another 1–2 minutes until golden brown and the cheese is melted.
5. Remove from the pan, cut into wedges, and serve.

3. Macaroni and Cheese

Ingredients

- 2 cups elbow macaroni
- 2 tablespoons butter
- 2 tablespoons flour
- 2 cups milk
- 2 cups shredded cheddar cheese
- Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Cook the macaroni in salted boiling water according to the package directions, then drain.
2. Melt the butter in a pot, whisk in the flour, and cook for about 1 minute.
3. Slowly whisk in the milk and cook until the sauce thickens.
4. Lower the heat, add the cheese, and stir until melted; season with salt and pepper.
5. Stir in the cooked macaroni and serve.

4. Scrambled Eggs

Ingredients

- 2–3 eggs
- 1 tablespoon butter
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 1 tablespoon milk or cream (optional)

Steps

1. Whisk the eggs with salt, pepper, and milk or cream if desired.
2. Melt the butter in a pan over low to medium-low heat.
3. Pour in the eggs and gently stir with a spatula.
4. Cook until the eggs are just set but still slightly soft.
5. Remove from heat and serve immediately.

5. Basic Tomato Pasta

Ingredients

- 8 oz pasta
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 can tomato sauce or crushed tomatoes
- Salt, pepper, and Italian seasoning

Steps

1. Cook the pasta in salted boiling water according to the package directions, then drain.
2. Heat olive oil in a pan and cook the garlic for about 30 seconds.
3. Add the tomato sauce, salt, pepper, and Italian seasoning, then simmer for 10 minutes.
4. Add the cooked pasta and toss until evenly coated.
5. Serve with Parmesan cheese if desired.